

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-A5: Textual Comparison and Advanced Commentary

Preserve a diplomatic base, classify witness differences, build a minimal apparatus, and write concise grammatical commentary

Stage	Stage IV — Advanced Reading and Composition
Prerequisite	EL-A4 and access to the exact identified witnesses required by the chosen collation
Next	EL-A6, Controlled Imitation

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

A5. Textual comparison and advanced commentary

Printed punctuation, capitalization, ligatures, and even word forms can differ among transcriptions and editions. An advanced reader records the witness before building an interpretation on a detail.

A **witness** is one particular document that preserves a text, such as a manuscript or printed copy. A page image is a surrogate for the document it reproduces; in these exercises it may stand for that witness when the physical copy is unavailable. An **edition** is an editor's presented text, usually based on one or more witnesses; a **transcription** is a representation that transfers the wording of a witness into another medium. Because a transcription can normalize or err, it is evidence about its source only to the degree that it represents that source accurately.

Textual comparison identifies and evaluates differences among such witnesses or representations. A **variant** is a difference in the text as presented. A **substantive variant** can alter wording, morphology, syntax, or sense; an **accidental** difference concerns such presentation features as spelling, capitalization, or punctuation unless that feature carries meaning in the case at hand.

On completing this unit, you can:

- collate short passages from page image and transcription;
- distinguish substantive variants from typography and punctuation;
- write a concise grammatical commentary; and
- document uncertainty and alternative analyses honestly.

1.1 A minimal collation

To **collate** is to compare corresponding passages systematically and record every relevant agreement and difference. The **base witness** is the copy against which the others are reported; choosing it organizes the record but does not prove that every one of its readings is original or correct. The **base text** is the wording printed as the commentary's main text.

Use the 1962 typical-edition page image as the base witness. On ruled paper, copy one line per phrase. Under it record each comparison witness. Classify a difference as:

- orthography (*æ/ae, j/i*);
- punctuation or capitalization;
- inflectional/morphological;
- lexical substitution, addition, omission, or transposition; or
- uncertain because the image or transcription is unreliable.

Do not silently create a hybrid text. For course exercises, a normalized form may be useful, but it must be labeled.

Normalization changes presentation to a declared standard—for example, consonantal *j* to *i*—without intending to change the underlying word or construction. A **hybrid text** silently combines readings from different witnesses. An **apparatus** is the compact record that identifies witnesses and reports their variants

against the base; it lets a reader distinguish documentary evidence from editorial choice.

1.2 The six-line commentary

A **grammatical commentary** is a sequence of focused notes that explains forms and constructions needed to understand a text. It differs from a translation, which gives continuous target-language sense, and from literary or theological commentary, which may build on grammar but answers broader questions. An **alternative analysis** is genuine only if it accounts for the attested form and context; a mere second English gloss is not an alternative parse.

For a difficult phrase, write no more than six lines initially:

1. lemma and morphology of the decisive form;
2. head/governor and local syntax;
3. clause relation;
4. contextually precise sense;
5. close parallel or source; and
6. a genuine alternative, ambiguity, or reason alternatives fail.

Only after this compact note should a longer literary or theological discussion be added. The constraint prevents commentary from avoiding the grammatical decision.

1.3 Rubrical register

A **rubric** is an authoritative direction governing the conduct of the rite, conventionally distinguished typographically from the words to be said. **Rubrical register** is the characteristic language of those directions: its function is instructional, even where its Latin uses an indicative rather than an imperative.

Rubrics commonly use an understood celebrant as subject, present indicatives as directions, participles for simultaneous action, and specialized adverbs of position or manner. Parse them as instructions before comparing them with prayer prose. A form's function in a rubric may be ordinary grammar in a specialized discourse setting rather than a unique "rubrical tense."

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 A minimal collation — transfer practice

Connection. A collation is reproducible only when the base, witnesses, lineation, uncertainties, and normalizations stay visible.

Transfer task. Before Worksheet IV.18, make a five-line mock apparatus with the project-composed base *Deus pacem donat*; let witness B print *Deus donat pacem* and witness C print *Dominus pacem donat*. Classify both without choosing a preferred reading.

Retrieval check. State which difference can affect emphasis and which changes the lexeme.

1.2 The six-line commentary — transfer practice

Connection. A concise note becomes checkable when every line answers a different evidentiary question.

Transfer task. Choose one form from the actual base and draft lines for morphology, governor/function, clause relation, contextual sense, checked parallel, and alternative or rejected parse.

Retrieval check. Cover the form and reconstruct which evidence belongs on each line.

1.3 Rubrical register — transfer practice

Connection. Instructional force belongs to discourse context; ordinary present, participial, and gerundive morphology still requires ordinary parsing.

Transfer task. Analyze the lesson's explicitly project-composed rubric-style example, then rewrite its circumstance as a finite clause and state the stylistic change.

Retrieval check. Why is present indicative not automatically a special rubrical tense?

1.4 Worked collation-to-commentary process — transfer practice

Connection. The commentary must be downstream of the established text, not a way to decide the text invisibly.

Transfer task. For one line of Worksheet IV.18, show the complete sequence: diplomatic transcription, differences, classification, normalized aid, selected reading if needed, then six-line note.

Retrieval check. Mark the first step at which editorial judgment is permitted.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

A5 worksheet family: textual comparison

Worksheet IV.18 — Build a minimal apparatus

Worksheet ID: IV.18

Focus: Record witnesses transparently.

Use: Use a 1962 page image and two transcriptions.

1. Transcribe eight lines from the page image, preserving spelling and punctuation.

-
2. Collate transcription 1 beneath the base.

-
3. Collate transcription 2 beneath the base.

-
4. Write a normalized reading line without losing the diplomatic base.

-
5. State which differences could affect grammatical analysis.
-

Worksheet IV.19 — Six-line commentary**Worksheet ID:** IV.19**Focus:** Make grammatical decisions concise.**Use:** Choose five difficult forms from one proper.

1. What belongs on line 1?

2. What belongs on line 2?

3. What belongs on line 3?

4. What belongs on lines 4–5?

5. What belongs on line 6?

6. Write one complete six-line note.

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Produce an accurate diplomatic base, a transparent classified apparatus against two named witnesses, and five concise notes whose morphology, syntax, sense, parallel, and alternative are independently checkable.

Scope of the two-session core. This packet proves collation and commentary. It does not prove independent rubrical-register reading; complete Worksheet IV.20 before claiming that separate skill.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-A6, Controlled Imitation.

If it is not met: Worksheets IV.17 and IV.20 remain optional variant-classification and rubrical-register practice.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

A minimal collation — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. B has transposition, potentially affecting order or emphasis without changing proposition; C has lexical substitution. The exercise is explicitly project-composed and demonstrates notation only, not a received variant.

The six-line commentary — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model requires one distinct answer per line and an exact witness or course reference for the parallel. A theological reflection cannot replace morphology, and a fabricated alternative is worse than a reason no material alternative survives.

Rubrical register — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The model parses subject, finite present, governed motion, and compressed circumstance normally. The rewrite makes the relation explicit but changes compression; register supplies directive force, not a new tense paradigm.

Worked collation-to-commentary process — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Transcription and difference recording precede judgment. A substantive decision may be made only after witnesses and classifications are visible; the note must cite that record and preserve residual uncertainty.

CHAPTER 2

A5 worksheet family: textual comparison

Solution IV.18 — Build a minimal apparatus

Worksheet ID: IV.18

Focus: Record witnesses transparently.

Use: Use a 1962 page image and two transcriptions.

1. Transcribe eight lines from the page image, preserving spelling and punctuation.
Answer / model: Compare letter by letter; mark illegible characters rather than guessing. The page image is the stated base witness.
2. Collate transcription 1 beneath the base.
Answer / model: Record only differences; classify each. Do not silently correct either witness.
3. Collate transcription 2 beneath the base.
Answer / model: As above; distinguish an independent agreement from copied error only if evidence permits.
4. Write a normalized reading line without losing the diplomatic base.
Answer / model: Label it “normalized” and list every normalization; substantive variants require an editorial decision and note.
5. State which differences could affect grammatical analysis.
Answer / model: Case/number/tense/person, missing particles, changed word, or punctuation that genuinely changes clause division merit discussion; ligatures alone do not.

Solution IV.19 — Six-line commentary

Worksheet ID: IV.19

Focus: Make grammatical decisions concise.

Use: Choose five difficult forms from one proper.

1. What belongs on line 1?

Answer / model: Lemma and complete morphology of the decisive form.

2. What belongs on line 2?

Answer / model: Its head/governor and local syntactic function.

3. What belongs on line 3?

Answer / model: Its clause and the clause's relation to the sentence.

4. What belongs on lines 4–5?

Answer / model: Precise contextual sense and a close source/parallel.

5. What belongs on line 6?

Answer / model: A genuine alternative or ambiguity, or a concise reason a tempting alternative fails.

6. Write one complete six-line note.

Answer / model: Answers vary; every line must use evidence. General theology cannot replace morphology and syntax.

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-A5, *Textual Comparison and Advanced Commentary*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. The selected core is collation plus commentary. Variant classification is supplied in transfer practice, while the full rubrical worksheet remains an explicit extension.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-21T17:50:56Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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